

I chose The Japanese Footbridge by Claude Monet, which I saw at the National Gallery of Art in Washington D.C., and I also have a recreation of it in my room, which made the experience more personal. I see this piece as both art and craft: it clearly demonstrates Monet's technical skill with color and light (craft), but more importantly, it reflects imagination and emotion (art). What drew me in was the softness and calmness of the scene, the way the colors blend yet radiate makes it feel almost dreamlike. It gives me a sense of peace and stillness, like time has slowed down. I think Monet was trying to capture a fleeting moment in nature and the beauty of light, but to me it represents escape and quiet reflection. While AI might be able to recreate the visual style, I don't think it could fully replicate the lived experience and intention behind it as Monet created his garden to paint it and his art captures all the energy and love he put into the whole process especially after he started losing his vision, his art remained beautiful and mesmerizing. In software, I think craft is writing clean, efficient, and functional code, while art is designing something intuitive and meaningful for users. I believe software should be both well crafted but also creative and thoughtful. When I code, I try to ask myself not just if it works, but if it's clean, readable, and something I'd be proud to show, and I do go back to refactor to improve it beyond just functionality.